

Odisha Gram Panchayat Development -- Analytical Findings Report

Department of Panchayati Raj & Drinking Water, Government of Odisha

Automated MetaInsight Analysis

Activity Lifecycle - Every Planned Work and Its Money

Sanction and Spending Remain Out of Step

Across costed activities, the total difference between voucher-linked spending and planned cost was Rs -51.96 crore. This was not confined to a few blocks: for 27 of the 28 recorded asset groupings, the difference was spread across all 16 blocks rather than concentrated in a small set. Banking Facilities did not show a clear distribution. The review response therefore needs to cover every block, not only those with the largest totals.

For activities with sanction records, the difference between spending and sanctioned funding was Rs -5.02 crore. This, too, was spread across the nine districts for 27 asset groupings; no single district accounts for the issue. These are net signed totals, so they establish spending below plan and sanction in aggregate, but do not identify individual activities where spending exceeded either amount.

Status records sharpen the concern. Activities marked Activity Approved accounted for 53.9% of costed activities, but their spending-minus-plan difference was Rs -41.61 crore. By contrast, WORK ONGOING activities accounted for 37.5% of costed activities and held Rs 28.59 crore, or 93.9%, of the Rs 30.43 crore general-component spending. This status pattern held in 18 Gram Panchayats; **Boipariguda** and **Laxmipur** showed no clear pattern and require activity-level examination.

Where the Planned Money Goes

Infrastructure dominates planned untied funding. Theme 6 – Self-sufficient Infrastructure in Village carried Rs 30.07 crore, or 50.4% of planned untied funding, against 32.6% of costed activities. This was the leading theme in 18 Gram Panchayats. The exceptions are important: **Boipariguda** was led by activities with no mapped LSDG theme, while **Kalimela** was led by Theme 4 – Water Sufficient Village. Officials should verify the underlying activity lists and theme mapping in both Gram Panchayats.

Planned tied funding is almost entirely attached to sanitation and drinking water across every recorded beneficiary grouping. Sanitation carried Rs 8.82 crore, or 49.9%, against 32.7% of costed

activities; drinking water carried Rs 8.42 crore, or 47.7%, against 18.1% of costed activities. This concentration is consistent with earmarked funding, but the review should still test whether the sanctioned works and voucher-linked spending follow the same focus areas.

Sanction Records and Classification Need Reconciliation

Chikilli has Rs 0 in sanctioned funding on record across every fiscal year from 2020-2021 to 2025-2026, although it accounts for 5.0% of all planned activities. The data cannot distinguish between no sanctions being issued and sanctions not being entered. This requires direct reconciliation with the Gram Panchayat and block records.

Asset information is also too incomplete for effective portfolio oversight. Among Public Works, 5,181 activities, or 55.0%, are Uncategorized; this means no usable asset category was available, not that “Uncategorised” is an asset type. The pattern holds in 19 Gram Panchayats, with **Govindapur** following a different distribution.

Output classifications are similarly unusable without departmental decoding. Two output categories with no description on file carried Rs 34.88 crore, or 62.1%, and Rs 16.90 crore, or 30.1%, of planned untied funding for Public Works. They represented 38.1% and 12.8% of Public Works activities respectively. This pattern held in 19 Gram Panchayats; **Haldikudar** was the exception. The department must supply the descriptions before these allocations can be interpreted operationally.

Evidence Is Concentrated in One Undecoded Output Category

For New/Fresh works, all 6,893 photo uploads in the analysed output split—100.0%—sit in one output category that has no description on file, although that category contains 32.8% of New/Fresh activities. The pattern held in 19 Gram Panchayats; **Chikilli** showed no clear pattern. Until the output codes are decoded, officers cannot tell whether this concentration is appropriate or whether other types of work lack recorded evidence.

Questions for the Departmental Review

- For **Chikilli**, were no activities sanctioned, or were sanction records not entered? Can the block reconcile every planned activity with its sanction and voucher-linked spending?
- Why do **Boipariguda** and **Kalimela** depart from the common planned untied-funding pattern, and are their activities mapped to the correct LSDG themes?
- Which individual activities have positive spending above plan or sanction, which Gram Panchayats recur, and which sanctioning offices approved those activities?

> **Reading note:** this view has one row for each of the **12,704 activities** the 20 Gram Panchayats planned, and three of its properties are features of the data rather than results. First, **costless activities** -- training, campaigns and services planned without a cost -- only began being reported in 2023-24, and they are 7,074 of the 12,704 rows, so activity counts rise about eightfold at that boundary for a reporting reason. Second, Sanction records exist for **2,101 of the 12,704 activities** (about one in six), so every sanctioned-basis figure -- sanctioned amounts, approval counts, and

overspend against sanction -- describes that subset only. An activity with no sanction record is **not** shown to be unapproved; it is shown to have no record on file. Third, only **17 activities are marked WORK COMPLETED** in the whole sample, so completion rates here measure recording practice, not delivery. Activity-count comparisons across FY 2023-24 reflect a change in reporting completeness (costless activities begin being recorded), not a change in activity.

Monthly Money Flows by Gram Panchayat

Linking Records Improved, While Cash Movement Remained Seasonal

Linking practice grew steeply over this window while the cashbook total did not, so a rise here is first of all a rise in how completely the link was recorded. This pattern appears at monthly, quarterly and fiscal-year levels. It is visible across Khordha, Ganjam, Kandhamal, Sundargarh, Malkangiri and Rayagada districts, but **Bargarh, Koraput and Cuttack** follow different patterns. At block level, the increase appears in nine of the 16 blocks; **Barpali, Bheden, Rangeilunda, Boipariguda, Baranga, Tangi Choudwar and Attabira** are the exceptions. These places require a check on whether cashbook payments are being linked consistently to planned activities.

Payments and receipts show a recurring annual cycle in both rupee amounts and voucher counts. March concentration is repeated across years, confirming that money movement remains weighted towards the fiscal year-end rather than being evenly spread. Expenditure linked to planned activities follows a shorter quarterly cycle, while sanction counts and sanctioned amounts do not follow the same regular annual pattern. The different timing of sanctions and cash movement should therefore be reviewed separately rather than treated as one process.

Payment Workload Is Concentrated in Bhubaneswar Block

Across the full period, the sample contains 8,529 vouchers for payments. **Bhubaneswar** block recorded 2,135 vouchers, or 25.0% of the total, and had the highest payment count in five of the six fiscal years. There was no clear leading block in 2024-2025. The next-largest recorded volumes were Rangeilunda with 945 vouchers and 11.1%, and Bheden with 885 vouchers and 10.4%.

These totals describe the concentration of transaction-processing workload, not performance. The recurring position of **Bhubaneswar** nevertheless warrants an operational review: can its Gram Panchayats and block-level reviewers show that the large voucher flow was entered, checked and reconciled throughout the year rather than mainly at year-end?

Ganjam and Bargarh Move Money Differently

In 2025-2026, **Ganjam** district stood out across total payment amounts, receipts, receipt vouchers, sanctions and expenditure linked to planned activities. It accounted for 26.1% of the 1,985 payment vouchers in that year. On the more comparable measure of a typical month for one Gram Panchayat, its payment amount was Rs 7.78 lakh, based on 48 Gram Panchayat-months. **Cuttack**

was close at Rs 7.58 lakh, based on 24 Gram Panchayat-months, while Khordha recorded Rs 5.49 lakh, based on 36 Gram Panchayat-months. District officials should therefore explain both Ganjam's high transaction volume and its relatively high monthly money movement per Gram Panchayat.

Within Bargarh district, **Bheden** block accounted for 57.2% of 1,546 vouchers and recorded a typical monthly payment amount of Rs 8.74 lakh, based on 72 Gram Panchayat-months. The comparable figures were Rs 2.28 lakh for **Barpali**, based on 144 Gram Panchayat-months, and Rs 2.22 lakh for Attabira, based on 72 Gram Panchayat-months. However, **Barpali**, not Bheden, recorded the highest sanction count and sanctioned amount and the most expenditure linked to planned activities. The block review should reconcile these different rankings across sanctions, total cashbook payments and recorded links to planned activities.

Sharp Timing Changes Need Explanation

In **Ganjam**, payment amounts, receipt amounts and their voucher counts all changed sharply around August 2020. Sanction counts and sanctioned amounts changed around October 2020. The data establishes the timing but not the reason; officials should verify whether these points mark real changes in cash movement, changes in entry practice, or both.

Questions for the Departmental Review

1. Why do **Bargarh**, **Koraput** and **Cuttack**, and the seven named exception blocks, not show the same improvement in linking cashbook payments to planned activities?
2. What explains the persistent March concentration, and which blocks have a month-by-month schedule for sanctions, receipts and payments to reduce year-end bunching?
3. In **Ganjam** and **Bargarh**, can officials reconcile the identified shifts and differing rankings against monthly cashbooks, receipt records and sanction registers?

> **Reading note:** this view's time axis is the **cashbook's own 72 months** (April 2020 to March 2026), and a Gram Panchayat month with no transactions is present as a row of zeros rather than absent -- 259 of the 1,440 cells are such months. Two consequences follow. Sanctions are counted by **sanction month**, so the **2,040** sanctions dated inside the window are here and **61** dated outside it are not; the yearly report card counts the full 2,101 by fiscal year, and both totals are correct for their own axis. And **March concentrates payments every year** -- 2,040 of the 8,529 payment vouchers fall in a March -- which is the fiscal-year end, a known property of government cash flow. On activity-linked expenditure specifically: the cashbook's total outflow did **not** grow across these six years (**Rs 15.60 crore** in 2020-21 against **Rs 11.12 crore** in 2025-26), while the share of it carrying a link to a planned activity rose from **2.7%** to **53.2%**, and the number of recorded activity-voucher links rose from **30** to **2,122**. A rise in activity-linked expenditure is therefore a rise in recording completeness unless the cashbook total rises with it. A dated event overlaps this section: the period this finding is restricted to falls inside and the shift this finding reports falls in the months just after the COVID-19 first-wave lockdown (2020-03 to 2020-06). The national COVID-19 lockdown was imposed on 25 March 2020 and unwound in phases through June 2020. Public works and Gram Panchayat office operations across Odisha were restricted for most of that window. The dates coincide; this analysis does not establish that one produced the other.

Gram Panchayat Report Card by Year

Sanctioned Value Is Declining Across Most Districts

The value of recorded administrative sanctions shows a decreasing year-over-year trend in Bargarh, Koraput, Cuttack, Sundargarh and Malkangiri. Across the full sample, the six-year sanctioned total was Rs 28.84 crore. The annual total was highest in 2020-2021 at Rs 6.13 crore, representing 21.2% of the six-year total, and lowest in 2025-2026 at Rs 3.57 crore, representing 12.4%.

The combined annual position was not a steady decline: recorded sanctions stood at Rs 4.45 crore in 2022-2023, Rs 4.56 crore in 2023-2024 and Rs 4.63 crore in 2024-2025. District review therefore needs to look beyond the state-level total and examine the individual Gram Panchayat trajectories in the five districts where the decrease is persistent.

Recorded sanctions cover only about one activity in six. A falling recorded value can therefore mean either that less work is being sanctioned or that sanctions are not being entered or linked to activities. District and block officials should be required to distinguish between these two readings before the figures are treated as a delivery decline.

The District Exceptions Need Different Review Questions

Kandhamal is the clear exception: its recorded sanctioned value follows an increasing rather than decreasing trend. The review should establish which Gram Panchayats account for that trajectory and whether their plans, sanctions, cashbook spending and geotagged evidence remain aligned year by year. A rising sanctioned value is not by itself proof that work was executed or evidenced.

No consistent direction was found in **Khordha**, **Ganjam** or **Rayagada**. These districts should not be grouped with either the decreasing districts or Kandhamal. Their Gram Panchayat report cards require year-specific examination to identify whether recorded sanctions fluctuate, disappear in particular years, or fail to correspond with planned and spent amounts.

Bargarh's Issues Are Broadly Spread, Not Confined to One Gram Panchayat

Bargarh's four sampled Gram Panchayats recorded 3,062 activities. Bheden accounted for 27.4% of that activity volume, Hirlipali for 25.4%, Bandhpali for 23.8% and Bhatigaon for 23.4%. These are close shares, so differences in their absolute totals must first be read in proportion to the amount of work each Gram Panchayat planned.

Across these Gram Panchayats, activity counts, recorded expenditure, administrative and technical sanction counts, ongoing activities, activities with geotagged evidence and photo uploads were broadly spread rather than concentrated in one place. The same applies to the signed differences between spending and planned or sanctioned amounts. This does not mean those differences are small or acceptable; it means that review action should cover all four Gram Panchayats rather than

search for a single outlier.

Important measures did not follow the same distribution. Planned cost, costed activities, cashbook payments and receipts were not part of the broad even pattern, while sanctioned value and completed activities showed no clear distribution pattern. Officials should reconcile these measures Gram Panchayat by Gram Panchayat. Evidence uploads being broadly spread also does not establish that evidence is adequate relative to the money spent.

Questions for the Departmental Review

First, in Bargarh, Koraput, Cuttack, Sundargarh and Malkangiri, which Gram Panchayats account for the decreasing sanctioned-value trajectory, and does each decrease represent fewer sanctions or missing sanction records?

Second, what distinguishes Kandhamal's increasing sanctioned-value trajectory, and are the corresponding works also visible in cashbook spending and geotagged evidence?

Third, for Bheden, Hiripali, Bandhpali and Bhatigaon, why do planned cost and cashbook flows follow a different distribution from activity volume, approvals, recorded expenditure and evidence uploads?

> **Reading note:** this view is a full grid -- all 20 Gram Panchayats against all 6 fiscal years, 120 rows -- so a **zero is a recorded zero**, not a missing row. It can mean either that nothing happened or that nothing was recorded, and this view cannot tell those apart. **Completion recording effectively ceased after 2022-23:** the 17 activities ever marked WORK COMPLETED fall 3 / 6 / 6 across 2020-21 to 2022-23, then 0, 2 and 0 across the three years since. No comparison of Gram Panchayats on completions can be supported by this column, and trend patterns on it are reported in the data-quality annex rather than as findings. Sanction records exist for **2,101 of the 12,704 activities** (about one in six), so every sanctioned-basis figure -- sanctioned amounts, approval counts, and overspend against sanction -- describes that subset only. An activity with no sanction record is **not** shown to be unapproved; it is shown to have no record on file. ``n_tech_approvals`` totals **2,095**, not the 2,134 technical-approval records in the source: 39 sit on activities that have no administrative approval, and the approval view hangs the technical approval off the administrative one. The Ask chatbot reports the same 2,095, so the two systems agree.

Data-Quality Annex

This section is generated from the mining run's own record, not written up from the findings. It lists what the analysis declined to report as a finding, and why -- so that a column nobody is filling in is visible as a recording problem rather than absent from the report or, worse, present in it as a performance result.

Gram Panchayat Report Card by Year

- **`n\_abandoned` over fiscal_year** carries too little non-zero data to support a time pattern: of the 46 series the engine would read, 28 fall below the guard (at least 4 non-zero points and at least 33% of the series non-zero), with between 0 and 6 non-zero points each. The column is non-zero on 54 of the view's rows. A time pattern over a series that is mostly zeros describes the recording, so none is reported as a finding.
 - **`n\_completed` over fiscal_year** carries too little non-zero data to support a time pattern: of the 46 series the engine would read, 42 fall below the guard (at least 4 non-zero points and at least 33% of the series non-zero), with between 0 and 4 non-zero points each. The column is non-zero on 7 of the view's rows. A time pattern over a series that is mostly zeros describes the recording, so none is reported as a finding.
 - **`n\_costless` over fiscal_year** carries too little non-zero data to support a time pattern: of the 46 series the engine would read, 46 fall below the guard (at least 4 non-zero points and at least 33% of the series non-zero), with between 3 and 3 non-zero points each. The column is non-zero on 60 of the view's rows. A time pattern over a series that is mostly zeros describes the recording, so none is reported as a finding.
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